

Private ▾ All regions ▾ Safe search: moderate ▾ Any time ▾

Generate answer for github stale branch



Search Assist



Stack Overflow

<https://stackoverflow.com/questions/29112156/what-is-a-stale-git-branch>

...

## github - What is a "stale" git branch? - Stack Overflow

A "Stale" git branch is a term I've heard a lot. I know it has something to do with branches which are regarded as less useful or useless, but cannot find an exact definition. What is a "stale" git branch?

The oldest reference to "stale" is found in commit e194cd1 (Jan. 2007, Git 1.5.0), which detected...

BEST ANSWER

👍 129

The definition of a stale branch, as per GitHub documentation, is a branch that has not had...

👍 89

That's because there is no "exact definition". "Stale git branch", "stale data", "stale configuration..."

👍 18

Stale branch without some stale



GitHub

<https://github.com/marketplace/actions/stale-branches>

...

## Stale Branches - GitHub Marketplace

Finds and deletes stale branches. By default it aligns with this definition, but can be configured for other use cases. When a branch has been inactive for more than the days-before-stale input, it is considered stale. The branch will be deleted once it has been inactive longer than days-before ...



christosmonogios.com

<https://christosmonogios.com/2026/04/02/how-to-clean-up-stale-git-branches-local-and-re...>

...

## How to clean up stale Git branches (local & remote) in minutes

Apr 2, 2026 · Uses git fetch --prune and git branch -vv to spot branches whose remote was deleted, then walks through safely deleting them locally and on the remote.



Stack Overflow

<https://stackoverflow.com/questions/22690969/how-do-i-identify-stale-dead-branches-in-git>

...

## How do I identify stale / dead branches in git? - Stack Overflow

I maintain a git repository which has a hundred or so branches on the central repository. Many of these branches were created for some purpose long served and are now inactive. Some branches might ...



Medium

<https://medium.com/@vbabak/how-to-deal-with-stale-branches-on-the-github-b49727480872>

...

## How to Deal With Stale Branches on the Github - Medium

In this article I want to show you a way how to deal with stale git branches on the Github. I suppose you are already familiar with git and Github, so it will be easy to read and understand ...



GitHub Docs

<https://docs.github.com/en/repositories/configuring-branches-and-merges-in-your-repositor...>

...

## Managing branches in your repository - GitHub Docs

Managing branches in your repository Whenever you propose a change in Git, you create a new branch. Branch management is an important part of the Git workflow. After some time, your list of branches may grow, so it's a good idea to delete merged or stale branches.

## What is a stale git branch

<https://stackoverflow.com/...>

The oldest reference to "stale" is found in commit e194cd1 (Jan. 2007, Git 1.5.0), which detected "stale tracking branches in remote": when tracking a branch which was removed by the remote system.

Hence git remote prune.

That is the main definition for **stale branch**: a remote tracking branch (a *local* reference of a remote repo branch) which no longer tracks anything (because the actual branch on the remote repo is gone).

git remote show is able to list those.

Incidentally, you have two other definitions of "stale" in the Git system:

Another reference to "stale" involves git reflog --stale-fix in commit 1389d9d (Git 1.5.0), for tracking "broken commit": a commit that is not reachable from any of the refs and there is a missing object among the commit, tree, or blob objects reachable from it that is not reachable from any of the refs.

That helps fixing situation after running non reflog-aware git prune from an older git in the presence of reflogs.

Commit 740fdd2 (March 2008, Git 1.5.5) also introduces "stale" for symbolic refs, when the ref they point to no longer exists.

As mentioned by @SteelToe: The definition of a **stale branch**, as per GitHub documentation, is a **branch** that has not had any commits in the previous 3 months.

This generally indicates an old/unmaintained/not current **branch**.

--VonC

github

Ask Duck.ai

Share Feedback



## Git Branch Aging Report: Finding and Cleaning Stale Branches

Jan 31, 2026 · **Stale** branches are hidden technical debt. Track **branch** aging, identify fossilized code, and automate cleanup safely.



Medium  
https://medium.com › @raghvendra.parulekar › stale-branch-deletion-in-github-e980bbcc67c5 ...

## Stale branch deletion in Github. Most of time we create ... - Medium

**Stale branch** deletion in **Github** Most of time we create branches to work on features but we forgot to delete those after merging code into main branches and those become **stale**. Later we realise ...



Github  
https://github.com › marketplace › actions › remove-stale-branches ...

## Remove Stale Branches - GitHub Marketplace

Remove **Stale** Branches This **GitHub** Action will identify **stale** branches and mark them for deletion after a set period. By default, branches are identified as **stale** if their latest commit is older than 90 days. This is useful for repositories that have many contributors that work on and off, and may forget to cleanup...

### Searches related to **github stale branch**

[remove stale branch from git workflow](#)

[git remove stale local branches](#)

[git list stale branches](#)

[removing stale branch from git](#)

[github remove stale branches](#)

[how to delete git branch](#)

[github delete all stale branches](#)

[gitlab stale branches](#)

[how to delete local branch from git](#)

[git delete old branch](#)

Was this helpful?

More Results



Get Our Windows Browser

Protect your data as you search, browse, and use AI.

Download